

Hebrew Canon: Law, Prophets and Writings (Psalms). And then there is Matthew 23:35—“so that upon you may come all the righteous blood shed on the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel up to the blood of Zechariah son of Berechiah, whom you murdered between the temple and the altar”. Jesus is here concluding His denunciation of the scribes and Pharisees. The murder of Abel is the first one recorded in the Bible (Genesis 4:8). Please note that Jesus affirms the historicity of Abel, and since Abel had parents, of necessity, Jesus is also affirming the historicity of Abel’s parents, Adam and Eve! Zechariah was a contemporary of Ezra and Haggai at the time of the construction of the second temple. So “all the righteous blood shed” between those two men covers the whole OT, some 3,500 years!

Having said all of the above, however, I recognize that to affirm the divine inspiration of the Bible is a declaration of faith—an intelligent faith that is based on evidences, but still faith, since the evidences are not absolute;¹ and they are not absolute for a very good reason. The Sovereign Creator deliberately does not allow the evidences to be absolute, because then there would be no true test. The Creator requires that men choose between good and evil, and the choice may not be coerced. That last night, in the upper room, Sovereign Jesus referred to the Holy Spirit as “the Spirit of the Truth” and declared that “He will guide you into all the truth” (John 16:13). It is the Holy Spirit’s prerogative to convict and convince.

Its nature

We use the term ‘inspiration’ to refer to the process that the Sovereign Creator used to produce his written Revelation. The Creator chose to use human authors, with the exception of the stone tablets containing the Decalog, that the Creator Himself engraved (Exodus 31:18, 32:16). By comparing the style of books written by different people, it is evident that the personality of the author was not squelched, or blocked: Paul writes in one way, John writes in a different way, and so on. And the same author will change style, depending on the intended audience, or recipient. So when Peter writes that the authors were “carried along by the Holy Spirit” (2 Peter 1:21), we may understand that the ‘carrying’ guaranteed that the words that were written expressed correctly the meaning that the Holy Spirit wished to convey. Both the living Word and the written Word involve a hypostatic union: how Jesus Christ can be 100% God and 100% man at the same time is a mystery; how the written Word can be 100% divine and 100% human at the same time is also a mystery.

¹ So we are not dealing with science, in an objective sense.